

FACILITATION GUIDE

How to run it.

Outcome: everyone leaves having watched one real example get sharper through good questions, then frames one pilot of their own with a date on it. Built for 45 minutes. The shaded rows show how to stretch it to 60.

You do not need to be an AI expert to run this. Your job is to keep time, read the cases aloud, and ask the questions on these pages. The group brings the industry knowledge. Stay curious, keep it light, and let the room do the thinking.

TIME	SEGMENT	WHAT YOU ARE DOING
0:00-0:04	Open + set the tone	Name the overwhelm, set the frame: today we leave with one small thing that works.
0:04-0:10	What a pilot is	Define safe-to-fail in plain words. Walk the four things that make one safe.
0:10-0:24	Work a case together	Read the RFI-drafting card aloud. Invite the group to pick it apart and make it stronger.
0:24-0:30	Read the flashlight	Score it: value ÷ weeks. Make the flashlight-not-verdict point.
0:30-0:40	Second case (expansion)	Work the estimating card. Use the 4.0 vs 2.5 contrast to show sequencing.
0:30-0:40	Their turn	Each person frames one pilot on the worksheet. Move around, offer one gentle question each.
0:40-0:48	Pairs (expansion)	Pairs help each other sharpen, using the card prompts.
0:40-0:45	Share + close	A few read theirs aloud. Close on start small, learn fast, bring it to your group.

Two rows share 0:30-0:40 on purpose: take the second case if you have 60 minutes, the solo round if you have 45.

0:00-0:04 OPEN, AND SET AN EASY TONE

The room may be a little wary of AI, and that is reasonable. Open on the feeling, not the technology, and keep it warm.

"Show of hands: who feels a little behind on AI? Keep it up if you also cannot tell which of the hundred tools out there actually matters. Good. We are not chasing any of that today. We are going to leave with one small thing that works."

0:04-0:10 WHAT A PILOT IS

Plain language only. A safe-to-fail pilot is one task, bounded, with a person in charge and a decision date. The aim is to learn quickly, not to be right the first time. Hold up the take-home so everyone can see the shape of it.

0:10-0:24 WORK A CASE TOGETHER

Read the RFI-drafting card aloud, then hand the thinking to the room. Your part is not to have the answers. It is to ask good questions and let the group make the idea better. Use the prompts on the card to get started, and keep it about the idea, never the person. The case belongs to no one here, so everyone can be honest without anyone feeling put on the spot.

A few gentle moves

Keep it on the idea. The case is nobody's, so nobody is on the defensive. If a comment drifts toward a person, guide it back to the card.

Slow down a quick yes. When the group waves something through, ask softly: "who checks the draft before it goes out, and what are they looking for?" A surfaced risk is a small gift to everyone.

Turn vague into measurable. "How would we know it worked, measured against what, without crediting a good week?"

Ask for the stopping point. "What would tell us to stop early, rather than run the full thirty days?"

0:24-0:30 READ THE FLASHLIGHT

The score is simple: rate value on a 100 to 500 scale, estimate time-to-value in weeks, then divide. Score the RFI-drafting case: value 300, about 4 weeks, so $300 \div 4 = 75$. Then the estimating card: value 400, the bigger prize, but about 8 weeks, so $400 \div 8 = 50$. The higher score is where to look first.

"Both are good ideas. The simple read says start with the faster payoff. High value on its own does not decide it. Value over time does. And the owner always makes the final call."

0:30-0:40 THEIR TURN

Hand out the worksheet. Each person frames one pilot from their own world. Move around the room and offer one gentle question each, not a critique. If someone reaches for the big, exciting idea, guide them kindly: "that might be pilot three. What is the small, safe one you could start first?"

0:40-0:45 SHARE, AND CLOSE

Invite two or three to read theirs aloud. Keep the feedback warm and brief. Then close simply.

"Start small. Learn fast. Then bring what you learn back to this group, because one pilot shared across the room is how a whole industry gets ahead. That is the table you are already part of."

No pitch at the end. If the session was useful, that speaks for itself.

If the room goes quiet: use the worked case as a model before asking anyone to try their own, or invite the most skeptical person to pick the RFI card apart first. Skeptics often make the best questioners, and the rest of the room tends to follow.

A NOTE ON THIS GUIDE

This kit is yours to use freely, with no strings. Anyone here can run the session. If your group would like help tailoring the cases to its specialty, or someone to lead the first run, just ask.